

purposes, use Bluetooth as just a spontaneous printing or transferring mode, if you don't have a USB cable. Also, the pairing of devices can be a bit tricky, requiring a bit of tinkering. And the connection once established, may not be very reliable.

There are a handful of digital cameras such as the Sony Cyber-shot DSC-G1 that allow you transmit photos over a wireless network using WiFi. Some of the newer WiFi-enabled digital cameras even let you send photos directly to an email address, or online photo sharing sites. WiFi lets you get over one of the most inherent crippling limitations in digital cameras - storage space. If your memory card is getting full, all you need to do is find a WiFi hotspot and you can offload all the data you want. One of the most important advantages of WiFi over Bluetooth is speed. So when you're faced with transferring 8 GBs of high-res images, all variants of WiFi will manage the job pretty quickly. But an 802.11 a/g/n camera is recommended. 'a/g/n' are the variants or protocols on which the WiFi 802.11 standard operates. WiFi is easy on the battery too, since it only operates in bursts while transferring. So, your battery, although being used up, will not dry out in a jiffy.

9.3 PictBridge

PictBridge is an industry standard that allows images to be printed directly from digital cameras to a printer, in effect bypassing the middleman — in this case, the PC. PictBridge operates through normal USB wires and connectors. Typically, a printer will have a type-

A connector while a PictBridge-enabled digital camera will have a Mini-B port. Once the two devices are connected, you can select and print images through the camera. For viewing and selecting photos, usually the camera's LCD interface is used. The user can navigate all the supported functions via menus on the LCD screen. The printer then retrieves the images from the camera and prints them. An advantage of Pictbridge is that it offers universal compatibility as each PictBridge device is automatically recognised by the other. To find out if a camera or printer is PictBridge enabled, look for the PictBridge logo on

